



A cartoon entitled "The concert of nations," in an 1897 edition of *Le Petit Journal*, satirizes the Thirty Days' War, also known as the Greco-Turkish War.



Four soldiers raise their rifles over the brush of San Juan Hill, Cuba, as they fight from trenches during the Spanish-American War.



Cyclists of the Lancashire Fusiliers took part in the South African War.

ALTHOUGH THE TEN YEARS' WAR HAD BEEN UNSUCCESSFUL

(see 1868), many Cubans were unwilling to accept continued control by Spain. Leading the renewed cries for independence was the **Cuban Revolutionary Party**. It declared a republic in eastern Cuba and began a guerilla war, known as the **Cuban War of Independence**. Soldiers managed to reach **Havana** by the following year, although they were driven back. The US would end up getting involved when the **battleship Maine was blown up** in the Havana harbor (see 1898).

Trouble was brewing between **Greece** and the **Ottoman Empire** over the situation in **Crete**. There had been a brutal suppression of a Christian uprising on the island the year before, and Greece was determined to annex the territory. However, the **Thirty Days' War** did not have the outcome Greece desired. When an armistice was agreed in August, it was forced to pay an **indemnity** and it lost part of the territory of **Thessaly**. The Turks withdrew their troops from Crete and the island was made an international protectorate.



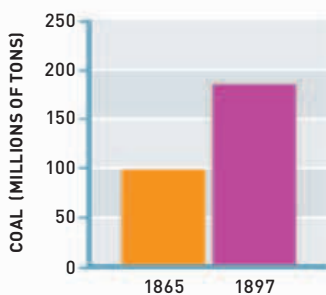
JOSE MARTI (1853–95)

A writer, philosopher, journalist, and political theorist, José Martí became a key figure in the Cuban revolutionary struggle. He is considered a national hero for his planning and leadership during the Cuban War of Independence. He died on the battlefield at Dos Ríos, in the east of the island.

Meanwhile, Britain was undergoing a remarkable **boom in coal mining**. The level of coal production had doubled since the 1860s. The mining industry was also a major employer—in 1897 the number of **miners** in Britain was around 695,200, rising from about 216,200 in 1851.

Coal mining in Britain

By 1897, Britain was the world leader in coal production. Its output of 200 million tons put it ahead of the US and Germany, who were also large coal producers.



WITH THE DESTRUCTION OF THE

USS Maine—blown up while docked in Havana's harbor—the **US** made the decision to go to **war against Spain**. Cuba's struggle for independence had already attracted much support in the US. The government blamed the *Maine* incident—in which **260 crew members were killed**—on Spain. Although Cuba and Spain had agreed an armistice on April 9, the US began the **Spanish-American War** only a few weeks later, on April 25. Battles were fought in two theaters: the Atlantic and the Pacific. US Navy ships sailed into Manila Bay, in the **Spanish Philippines**, while another fleet made incursions into the southern harbor of Cuba, **Santiago**, where troops then disembarked. By July 25, **Spain had capitulated**. It would pay a steep price for what the US Secretary of State John Hay (1838–1905) called "a splendid little war" in a letter to his friend and future US president **Theodore Roosevelt** (1858–1919), who had led the First Volunteer Cavalry (known as the "Rough Riders"). Under the terms of the **Treaty of Paris** of December 10, Spain had to give up its remaining colonies, **allowing Cuba its independence** and ceding Puerto Rico, Guam, and the Philippines to the US. However, the US continued to occupy Cuba, and the following year tried to exclude Cubans from governing, and disbanded the army. Around the same time the US also managed to annex the islands of **Hawaii**.



Hawaii annexed

In a contemporary illustration, Hawaiians in Honolulu receive news of their annexation by the US. The US would also take control of Guam and the Philippines.

Meanwhile, in **Egypt**, Britain and France became embroiled in the **Fashoda Incident**, which involved territorial disputes over their respective attempts at expansion in Africa. The British wanted to build a **railroad linking Egypt and Uganda** while France wanted to continue its eastward drive into the **Sudan**. Although their troops met in Fashoda on September 18, the situation did not escalate into war, as all sides wanted to **avoid battle**. Instead they decided that British, French, and Egyptian flags should fly over the fort that the French had occupied. Eventually, they agreed that their **boundaries** would be marked by where the **Nile and Congo rivers** divided.

HOSTILITIES BETWEEN THE

BOERS AND BRITISH were once again heading toward conflict. They had already clashed in the **First Boer War** (see 1880). This time Boers were demanding that British troops protecting mining interests should withdraw from the **Transvaal**, but this request was ignored. So the South African Republic and the Orange Free State **declared war** on Britain in October. The **South African War** would last less than three years but, for the British, it would become the largest since the Napoleonic Wars, as its forces reached some 500,000 men. The war was fought across a **hostile terrain**, which the Boers—whose troops numbered less than 90,000—could use to their advantage. The war became infamous because of the **treatment of Boer civilians**, who saw their farms burned and women and children put into **camps** where up to 25,000 died.



War medal

The Queen's South Africa Medal, awarded to military personnel who served in the war, is engraved with a Jubilee bust of Queen Victoria.

August 29 The First Zionist Congress convenes in Basle, Switzerland

September 20 Greece and Turkey sign peace treaty, ending Thirty Days War

January 1 City of Greater New York created by uniting neighboring boroughs

February 15 USS Maine explodes and sinks in Havana harbor—Spanish sabotage suspected

April 9 Armistice between Spain and Cuba

April 25 US declares war on Spain

December 10 Treaty of Paris signals end of Spanish-American War

January 1 Puerto Rico ceded to US

July 29 Peace Conference at the Hague establishes an international court of arbitration

October 11 Start of South African War, between British and Boers (to 1902)

November Sigmund Freud (1856–1939) publishes *The Interpretation of Dreams*